Best Buys and Consumer Decisions

Concept

A best buy compares the cost of equal quantities and the amount you will use.

Unit price

Price ÷ quantity; compare in matching units.

Discount

Sale price = original × (1 − discount rate).

Final cost

Apply stated coupons, taxes and fees in the stated order.

Value

Consider waste, storage, quality and your budget too.

Example 1

Compare 750 g for $4.50 with 1.2 kg for $6.60.

Solution

1. First: 4.50/0.75 = $6/kg.
2. Second: 6.60/1.2 = $5.50/kg → cheaper per kilogram.

Best Buys and Consumer Decisions

Example 2

A $60 jacket is 20% off, then subject to a stated 5% classroom tax.

Solution

1. Sale price $= 60(0.80) = \$48.$

2. Total $= 48(1.05) = \$50.40.$

Best Buys and Consumer Decisions

Practice | your turn

Show your steps. Include units and restrictions where needed.

1. Which is cheaper per litre: 500 mL for $2.40 or 1.5 L for $6.30?

2. Find the total for an $80 item after a 25% discount and then a stated 10% tax.

3. Three identical items cost $9 with a 'buy two, get one free' offer at $4.50 each. Find the effective unit price.

4. For $40, apply 20% off then a $5 coupon. Compare with applying the coupon first and then 20% off.

Best Buys and Consumer Decisions

Practice answers | check after trying

1. $4.80/L versus $4.20/L; the 1.5 L package has the lower unit price.

2. $80(0.75)(1.10) = \$66$.

3. $9/3 = \$3$ per item.

4. Discount then coupon: $40(0.80) - 5 = \$27$. Coupon then discount: $(40 - 5)(0.80) = \$28$. The first order saves $1 more, if permitted.